

Try Your Hand at the Dropbox API for Android

For cloud and Android developers, Dropbox is a very handy service. It offers cloud storage and a nifty tool to sync data. One of Dropbox's biggest advantages is that it is so simple and easy to use—particularly the developer API provided. This allows developers to harness the power of the cloud effectively. This article will focus on the basics of the Dropbox API, and how to integrate it with your Android apps.



Before we get started, you need to set up Eclipse and the Android SDK on your system; there's plenty of information about that on the Net, so I'll skip it.

Setting up Dropbox access

Setting up the Dropbox access for your app is relatively easy and straightforward. First you have to go to the *Apps* page of your Dropbox account (<https://www.dropbox.com/developers/apps>) and then create a new app. Once it is created, you will get the app key and the app secret key. These are unique values to your app, and are used for authenticating the connection between Dropbox servers and your app, and hence should not be shared. Also note the type of access specified when you create your app. There are two types of access you can specify: **DROPBOX**, which allows your app to access your entire Dropbox folder, or **APP FOLDER**, which only allows your app to access the folder specifically created for your app. Now, let's proceed to create a new Android project in your Eclipse environment.

Configuration

Once you have created your Android project in Eclipse, download the Dropbox SDK for Android from the Dropbox site (<https://www.dropbox.com/developers/reference/sdk>).

Extract the files, and copy the contents of the *lib* folder into your Android project's *lib* folder. You can use the *DBRoulette* sample project in the *examples* folder as reference while doing this. After copying the libraries, tweak the *AndroidManifest.xml* file so that your app has sufficient permissions to access the required resources. Add the following code to your *Manifest* file, under the application tag:

```
<activity
    android:name="com.dropbox.client2.android.AuthActivity"
    android:launchMode="singleTask"
    android:configChanges="orientation|keyboard">
    <intent-filter>
        <!-- Change this to be db- followed by your app key
-->
        <data android:scheme="db-APP-KEY" />
        <action android:name="android.intent.action.VIEW" />
        <category android:name="android.intent.category.
```